circumstances and domestic pressures as:

- Security
- Autonomy
- Welfare in the broadest sense
- Status and prestige.

Not all the states pursue similar kinds of priorities and there may be options between ‘guns’ and ‘butter’. Foreign policy objectives can, therefore, be described as “the discovery of goals as much as it involves using decisions to achieve particular outcomes”. The objectives, may include projecting “image of future state of affairs and future conditions that governments through individual policy makers aspire to bring about by wielding influence abroad and by changing or sustaining the behavior of other states”. Objectives may be immediate, concrete or abstract, long-term or less concrete. Expansion of territory like China’s aim in Tibet, or China’s boundary tussles with India, and the wars fought and persisting animosity over the border issues, several wars in the Middle East like the Iran–Iraq war over the control of Shatt al-Arab, or Iraq’s attack on Kurdistan may be seen as involving concrete objectives. Promotion of specific set of values like “making the world safe for democracy”, creating a new world order, such as the demand for New International Economic Order, or “War on Terror” may be visualized as long-term and abstract objectives. Sometimes governments pursue incompatible objectives, either incompatible with the objectives of another state as was the case during the Cold War days between the United States and the Soviet Union, or incompatible with their domestic objectives. This was the case with the Nixon administration’s wheat deal with the Soviet Union in 1971–1972 which on the one hand aimed to help in the betterment of relations with the Soviet Union, thereby facilitating American withdrawal from Vietnam and on the other hand tried to control inflation, prices of foods and ensuring the well-being of American society.

Undoubtedly, the ends that the states seek vary from one state to another depending on several factors such as geo-strategic location,